Discuss and Possibly Adopt Revisions to Board Policy EHBB (Local)

Proposal:
That the Board of Trustees consider and discuss revisions to Local Board Policy EHBB (Local) Special Programs: Gifted and Talented Students.

Explanation:
The Administration recommends consideration and discussion of the revisions to Board Policy EHBB Special Programs: Gifted and Talented Students. The Administration recommends that the updated Local Board Policy EHBB (Local) be adopted as presented.

Policy Reference: EHBB Local

Recommended by:

Dr. David Vinson
Superintendent of Schools

Conroe ISD (conroe-isd)

Special Programs: Gifted and Talented Students (EHBB)

Policy Type: Local Policy

Date Issued: 2022-06-08

Version: 1

Referral

Students may be referred for the gifted and talented program at any time by teachers, school counselors, parents, or other interested persons.

Screening And Identification Process

The District shall provide assessment opportunities to complete the screening and identification process for referred students at least once per school year.

The District shall schedule a gifted and talented program awareness session for parents that provides an overview of the identification ~~assessment~~ procedures and services for the program prior to beginning the screening and identification process.

Parental Consent

The District shall obtain written parental consent before any special testing or individual assessment is conducted as part of the screening and identification process. All student information collected during the screening and identification process shall be an educational record, subject to the protections set out in policies at FL.

Identification Criteria

The Board-approved program for the gifted and talented shall establish criteria to identify gifted and talented students. The criteria shall be specific to the state definition of gifted and talented and shall ensure the fair assessment of students with special needs, such as the culturally different, the economically disadvantaged, and students with disabilities.

Assessments

Data collected through both objective and subjective assessments shall be measured against the criteria approved by the Board to determine individual eligibility for the program. Assessment tools may include, but are not limited to, the following: achievement tests, intelligence tests,

creativity tests, behavioral checklists completed by teachers and parents, student/parent conferences, and available student work products.

Selection

A placement ~~selection~~ committee shall evaluate each referred student according to the established criteria and shall identify those students for whom placement in the gifted and talented program is the most appropriate educational setting. The committee shall be composed of at least three professional educators who have received training in the nature and needs of gifted students, as required by law.

Notification

The District shall provide written notification to parents of students who qualify for services through the District's gifted and talented program. Participation in any program or services provided for gifted students shall be voluntary, and the District shall obtain written permission from the parents before placing a student in a gifted and talented program.

Reassessment

If the District reassesses students in the gifted and talented program, the reassessment shall be based on a student's performance in response to services and shall occur no more than once in elementary grades, once in middle school grades, and once in high school grades.

Transfer Students

Interdistrict

When a student identified as gifted by a previous school district enrolls in the District, the placement ~~selection~~ committee shall review the student's records and conduct assessment procedures when necessary to determine if placement in the District's program for gifted and talented students is appropriate.

[See FDD(LEGAL) for information regarding transfer students and the Interstate Compact on Educational Opportunities for Military Children]

Intradistrict

A student who transfers from one campus in the District to the same grade level at another District campus shall continue to receive services in the District's gifted and talented program.

Furloughs

The District may place on a furlough any student who is unable to maintain satisfactory performance or whose educational needs are not being met within the structure of the gifted and talented program. A furlough may be initiated by the District, the parent, or the student.

In accordance with the Board-approved program, a furlough shall be granted for specified reasons and for a specified period of time. At the end of a furlough, the student may reenter the gifted and talented program, be placed on another furlough, or be exited from the program.

Exit Provisions

The District shall monitor student performance in response to gifted and talented program services. If at any time the placement ~~selection~~ committee or a parent determines ~~it is in the best interest of the student to exit~~ the program is not meeting the student's educational needs, the committee shall meet with the parent and student before finalizing an exit decision.

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Appeals

A parent, student, or educator may appeal any final decision of the placement ~~selection~~ committee regarding ~~selection for or exit from~~ services in the gifted and talented program. Appeals shall be made first to the placement ~~selection~~ committee. Any subsequent appeals shall be made in accordance with FNG(LOCAL) beginning at Level Two.

Program Evaluation

The District shall annually evaluate the effectiveness of the District's gifted and talented program, and the results of the evaluation shall be used to modify and update the District and campus improvement plans. The District shall include parents in the evaluation process and shall share the information with Board members, administrators, teachers, school counselors, students in the gifted and talented program, and the community.

Funding

The ~~District's~~ Superintendent or designee shall develop administrative procedures to account for the expenditure of the gifted and talented allotment in alignment with the Texas Education Agency's financial compliance guidance. ~~program shall address effective use of funds for programs and services consistent with the standards in the state plan for gifted and talented students.~~

One hundred percent of state funds allocated for gifted and talented education shall be spent on providing gifted and talented services or enhancing the District's gifted and talented program.

Community Awareness

The District shall ensure that information about the District's gifted and talented program is available to parents and community members and that they have an opportunity to develop an understanding of and support for the program.

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